

**Regular Meeting
Monday, October 7, 2019
Medford School Committee
Medford High School**

Present: Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, and Ms. DiBenedetto arrived at 7:17pm.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:16pm.

Approval of the Minutes of September 23, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Ms. DiBenedetto - Did we replace gymnastics equipment? Ms. Patterson - Yes, floor replacement. Ms. DiBenedetto - NWEA? Ms. Patterson - That was a grant. Ms. Caldwell - Maps Growth Testing Company. Ms. DiBenedetto - The math learning supplies are just arriving or they have not arrived yet? Ms. Patterson - We would have already received them. Mr. Ruggiero - Are we all set with air compressors and HVAC? Ms. Patterson - Yes. Mr. Ruggiero - What is DW Government? Ms. Patterson - We have a contracted service to monitor our internet and technical devices such as laptops. Mr. Ruseau - Unclassified expenses for National Grid? Mayor Burke - That is a revolving account. Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report of Committees - Rules Subcommittee - Attendance Policy - October 1, 2019 - Ms. Kreatz - We decided that the subcommittee will post an attendance policy similar to the policies in other area districts. Mr. Ruseau will contact MASC to ask them for their official policy. The members of the subcommittee can work together online to edit the document and when it is ready, we can share it with the administrative team. We will then meet again as a subcommittee and vote to take it to the regular meeting. We decided that the policy that if a student is absent on a Friday they may not participate in activities on Saturday or Sunday is a procedural change. We recommend that change. Ms. Van der Kloot - Another thing that was discussed was that there are many policies that should be changed as they are not up to date on the website now. Ms. Kreatz - We updated several chapters of policies in the spring and it is very time consuming. Ms. Van der

Kloot - It should be brought to the floor. Ms. Kreatz - We have been. Ms. Van der Kloot - We are on the same page. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Motion to suspend the rules to take paper 3 out of order offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Report on Partnership for Advanced Leadership Skills (PALS) Program - Chief Jack Buckley and Stacey Schulman - We wanted to create a program to have police officers in elementary schools to read to students, to engage with them in grades K to 5 and address social-emotional learning and keep a police presence in the schools. There is a safety and security aspect but there is also the fact that the police can be seen as a helpful presence. Ms. Schulman - Social skills lunch groups, drug education and police being trained in the Michigan Model. Mr. Ruggiero - I saw a program about giving tickets for positive behavior which was used to great effect. Chief Buckley - We do want to make sure we are having positive interactions with kids. Mr. Ruseau - Will someone monitor the interactions? Ms. Schulman - Yes. Chief Buckley - I think the program could be part of a study of the longer term effects. Ms. DiBenedetto - How many officers? Will they be at all schools? The same officers at the same schools to build relationships or alternate? Chief Buckley - We have 12-16 officers who will be trained initially but ultimately all officers will be trained in the Michigan Model. As far as PALS/DARE it will be the same core officers so the students will recognize them. I want all my officers in the schools. I want them to see and interact with different officers. Ms. DiBenedetto - Is there any cost involved? Ms. Schulman - I purchased some books, we may purchase some more books. This time I secured grant funding for the books. Ms. DiBenedetto - I think consistency for the younger children is important to build relationships. I like the idea of this program. Ms. Kreatz - Will there still be DARE graduation? Ms. Schulman - Yes, it will be PALS graduation. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you, especially the part about revamping the DARE education to fit within the Michigan Model which includes vaping education. Motion to receive report and place on file offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Motion to revert to regular order of business offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Report of the Superintendent - Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Last week, students taking Italian at Medford High School attended Pagliacci, an Italian opera. This was such a great opportunity for our students. Our World Language Department always tries to teach cultural enrichment along with teaching the languages.

To follow up on the first season of our middle schools sports program: currently, the Mustangs all have winning records. Boys and Girls Cross Country are 3-0. Softball is 3-2 and Baseball is 4-1.

Dr. Stacey Mulligan, our Grade 10 Assistant Principal also took on the role of Diversity and Inclusion Coordinator for the Medford Public Schools. Dr. Mulligan plans to conduct a few new initiatives this year, including instituting implicit bias/cultural competency training district-wide, host a 4-part Symposium Series discussing race and education, and establishing the Medford chapter of ALANA Educators - ALANA (African, Latino, Asian and Native American).

The McGlynn third graders received a visit from the Medford Rotary Club who provided the students with dictionaries and bookmarks. The Medford Kiwanis Club made financial donations to CCSR, the Mustang Cheerleaders and the Mustang Athletic Department.

Along with Mayor Burke and Dr. Cushing, I attended the first of the Greater Boston PFLAG presentations which was held at the Andrews Middle School. This presentation will also be held at the McGlynn Middle School and Medford High School.

The McGlynn 8th graders participated in a field trip to learn about the college process at Tufts University.

Medford Public Schools continues to provide free breakfast for all students. It is our hope that all students will take the opportunity to start the day with a healthy breakfast.

Yom Kippur begins tomorrow at sundown. It is the holiest day of the Jewish year. I extend all good wishes to all of our Jewish friends as they begin this solemn holiday.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Can you let the School Committee know when the PFLAG presentation will happen? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I will get the dates and send them to you. Ms. DiBenedetto - I have heard that the middle school buses are arriving too close to the start of classes for the kids to have time to get breakfast before the bell rings. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I will follow up with transportation. Mr. Ruggiero - What food are we offering for breakfast? Ms. Patterson - We are offering a hot option at every school building. We are looking to build participation. After the three month pilot I will give a comprehensive report with counts, but we are doing a full scale hot breakfast option. We are trying to encourage participation as much as possible. Mr. Ruggiero - How is participation so far? Ms. Patterson - We have had increased participation, but not to the level we need. Mr. Ruseau - Transportation is always an issue. This morning the Andrews bus got in at 8:10, long after the breakfast would be done. Does the kitchen staff stop? Ms. Patterson - This morning a bus driver was sick, so they scrambled. We have been adamant at all the

buildings that when buses arrive, students disembark and go to breakfast immediately. To my knowledge that is what they have done. We have had some issues with the MBTA buses, but we can only do so much to provide the meal, the students still have to come take it.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip to Argentina - Nelida Lepore - The trip is a far flight and it is expensive, but we are hoping to have interest. The tour guide is coming to fine tune the itinerary, I am hoping the students can visit a high school. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll call vote

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report on Buildings and Grounds Security Update - John McLaughlin - Buildings and Grounds has a high stake in the security of our school district. I have been auditing the district with Lieutenant Covino, assessing our needs. I have been monitoring our technology needs. We have been working with the Police Department to make sure the buildings are secure. We are working to designate parking for students at the high school. We are looking into our communications systems throughout the district. We are working on the See Something Say Something App that students can report anything they observe. We want to be transparent, though we cannot always say what exactly we are working on. We have a plan and a list, but we cannot say specifics. We have the Raptor system and monitors at doors. At the high school we have updated things so that you sign the person in on the Raptor system and call ahead so the person they are going to see is expecting them. We are continuously trying to improve on a system we have that is pretty good. Mr. Ruseau - Where do the reports from the See Something Say Something App go? Mr. McLaughlin - I assume it goes to one person who disseminates them. It could be that it comes to me because it is a buildings and grounds issue. I think it is like the 311 system. Mr. Ruseau - Once it is up for 30 days or so can you report to us how many you have gotten? Mr. McLaughlin - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - Motion to move forward with studying the security director position so when the app is in place there is someone who can respond to the reports, as a budget request. Seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Do we need more parking spaces because more students are driving to school? Mr. McLaughlin - It is more of an issue on weekends than during the week. We are trying to consolidate student parking so we know staff is in one area and students are in one area. The front area should be for students because there is great camera coverage. Mr. D'Alleva has been handing out passes to get a handle on who is parking out there. We want to reinstitute that. The parking issue is really the weekends. Mr. Ruggiero - See Something Say Something has a police connotation to me. Would a broken light go in the same bucket as a serious security

concern? Mr. McLaughlin - No, I do not have a concern it will be taken lightly. Mayor Burke - It is a Sandy Hook app. Mr. Ruseau - Are we scheduling things to start and end at the same time? Mayor Burke - It is usually a ten minute break. Mr. Ruseau - Everybody has to park at the same time. But we can solve it by scheduling thoughtfully.

Motion to accept report with amendment to add Head of Security position in budget discussion 2020-2021 offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on Ongoing Math Learning Walks - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We will continue with our math learning walks, hopefully you will join us. We will continue to partner with Lesley University. The month of October is when we collect our baseline data. I look forward to updating you in the future. Mr. Ruggiero - Please update us on how our EL students are doing in math. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, we will observe EL students, students with disabilities, large classrooms, small classrooms, and have a balanced view of what is going on in the districts. Ms. DiBenedetto - Please add my requested report for an update on math supplies and consumables to the agenda. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Condolences were read for Charles Ferrante, Angela Keddy, Anthony Ardagna, and Leo "Skip" Dervishian.

Motion to adjourn offered by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes. Meeting adjourned at 8:12pm.